nation prospered? Is it not enough that our national pride remained untarnished?

In a conversation with Bharati, K.R. Venkatarama Aiyar had told him that it would not be a good practice to accept contributions without issuing receipts, and therefore suggested that such public contributions should be made to the company under the supervision of a few trustees; the company could treat this as being part of share capital, and use the dividends from this investment to send Indian youths to Japan to be trained in navigation and maritime technologies. Bharati had little patience for such proposals: all that was required was that funds should reach the company, and 'our national pride should not suffer.' Asking for funds to be sent to the *India* office, he helpfully added that its proprietor Mandayam S. Srinivasachari—whom we already encountered as an investor in the company—was also raising a fund for the same purpose. All contributions would be saved in a bank account, and once a substantial sum was accumulated it would be remitted to Tuticorin. 'We don't care what steps you will take. Somehow two lakh rupees should reach Tuticorin …' he declared.

Bharati did not stop with appealing to patriots. For good measure, he directed barbs at the moderate Congress leaders. Firstly, he asked, what was the National Fund collected in Madras being used for? 'We would like to be informed if the Swadeshi company has received any help from this fund? If it cannot be used for such a national effort what is the damned purpose of such a fund?' he declaimed angrily. The next barb was directed personally at the Moderate Congress-man V. Krishnaswamy Aiyar who claimed to support 'a pure form of Swadeshi untainted by boycott [of foreign goods]'. 'Why does he not support this cause from the huge fund he has amassed? Can he not use his influence to persuade the merchant class who come to litigate to make contributions to the Swadeshi company? His words are empty talk. It is futile to expect help from such impostors. This is a country of poor people. This effort is that of poor people. It is we, the poor, who should support this cause.'[117]